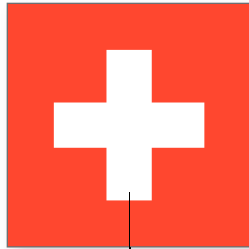


Switzerland

Ratio: 1:1 **Adopted:** December 12, 1889 **Usage:** National and Civil

The red field with a white cross was adapted from the flag of Schwyz, one of the original three cantons



The Swiss and Vatican flags are the only square national flags

A white couped cross

Europe



In 1291, a small confederation was formed to resist Austrian rule, beginning modern **Switzerland**. More cantons joined up to 1815.

The flag of Switzerland is one of the most typical European flags. In medieval times many European states used a plain flag with a cross.

A FLAG FOR THE CONFEDERATION

For many years, the separate cantons of Switzerland had no one common flag, but were each represented by their own flags. The present flag of Switzerland, a white couped cross on a red field, was based on that of Schwyz, one of the three original provinces which united into a confederation against the Holy Roman Empire in 1291. It became accepted as the common badge of the Confederation in 1339 at the Battle of Laupen, when it was used to

distinguish the soldiers of the Confederation from other soldiers, and became the accepted flag of the Confederation in 1480. It was not officially confirmed as the flag of Switzerland until 1848 and it was last regulated in 1889.

Apart from that of the Vatican, the Swiss flag is the only totally square national flag. However, when used on the Swiss lakes it has the ratio of 2:3; a practice adopted in 1941.

THE NATIONAL ARMS

The coat of arms is simply a shield in the form of the flag. It was officially adopted in 1889. Every town or commune in Switzerland has its own flag and coat of arms.